2. Mid continental belt

This is the volcanic zone of convergent continental plate boundaries that includes the volcanoes of *Alpine mountain chains*, the *Mediterranean Sea and the fault zone of eastern Africa*. The important volcanoes are Vesuvius, Stromboli, Etna, Kilimanjaro and Kenya. Surprisingly, the Himalayas have no active volcanoes at all.

3. Mid Atlantic Belt

This belt represents the divergent boundary of plates located along the mid-Atlantic ridges. Volcanoes of this area are mainly of fissure eruption type. Iceland is the most active volcanic area and is located on the mid-Atlantic ridge. St. *Helena* and *Azores* Island are other examples.

Summary

- The Earth's interior structure is compared with that of an apple
- The crust is the outer-most layer of the earth.
- The upper part of the earth crust is SIAL.
- The lower part of the earth crust is SIMA.
- The mantle is about 2900km thick.
- The lithosphere is broken into a number of plates known as the lithospheric plates
- The earthquake waves are recorded by an instrument known as seismograph.
- Tsunami is caused by an underwater earthquake.
- A Volcano is vent or opening in the earth crust through which magma comes out.
- The Shape of a volcano depends on the type of lava and force of the eruption.
- There are three major zone of volcanic activity in the world.

Glossary		
Core	The inner most layer of the earth	கருவம்
Mantle	The second layer beneath the crust	கவசம்
Mohorovicic discontinuity	Boundary that separated the mantle from the crust	மோஹோரோவிசிக் எல்லை
Land slide	Downward movements of rock debris of the mountain	நிலச்சரிவு
Seismograph	Instrument to measures the magnitude of an earthquake	சீஸ்மோகிராப்
Tsunami	Sea waves caused by an underwater earthquake or a volcanic eruption under sea.	ஆழிப்பேரலை
Vent	An opening a the earth surface from which volcanic material is emitted	எரிமலைவாய்
Magma	The molten state of rocks	பாறைக்குழம்பு
Lava	The solidified form of magma after it reaches the surface of the earth	எரிமலைக்குழம்பு

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